Vendor Payment & Procurement System (VPPS)

Transforming procurement from reactive manual processes to demand-driven payments and real-time cashflow visibility

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SECTION 01

The Brief

In early 2025 I identified that Cre8iveSkill's procurement and vendor payment workflow was a major operational constraint that directly affected cash flow, vendor trust, and production continuity. The finance team was spending roughly 120 hours per month on invoice processing — manually matching invoices to purchase orders, routing approvals by email, and executing payments — which created delays and missed opportunities for early-payment discounts.

I led the design and delivery of a Vendor Payment & Procurement System (VPPS) that integrated procurement with our production platform, automated invoice processing, introduced demand-driven PO generation, and surfaced real-time cashflow visibility for management. My role covered the full BA lifecycle: stakeholder interviews across finance, procurement, production and vendors; as-is process mapping to quantify delays; writing a BRD with clear acceptance criteria and business rules; and translating requirements into prioritized user stories for development.

The solution architecture combined electronic invoice submission, automatic PO matching, intelligent approval workflows, duplicate detection, and bank transfer automation — all designed to reduce manual effort, improve vendor predictability, and enable data-driven procurement decisions.

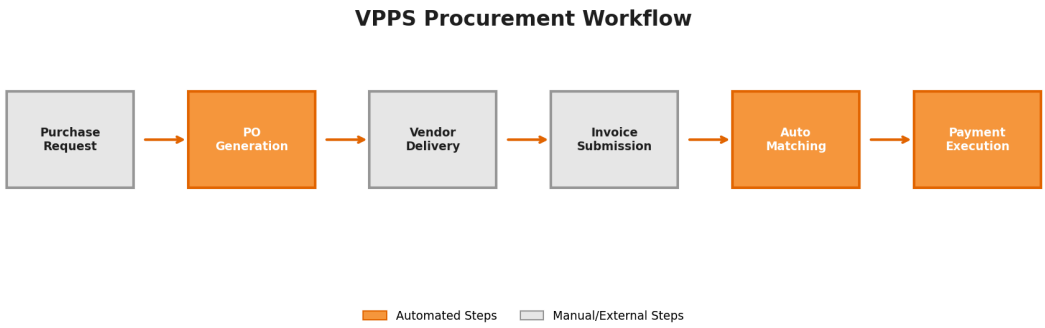

Figure 1: VPPS End-to-End Procurement Workflow

120 Hours/Month	**65%** On-Time	**5-7** Days Invoice
Manual Processing	Payment Rate	Processing Time

SECTION 02

The Challenge

The challenge was multi-dimensional. Operationally, invoices routinely sat in inboxes for 5–7 days before being processed; duplicate invoices and inconsistent approval routing created rework and payment errors. Vendors reported unpredictable payment timing, often waiting 30–60 days despite agreed terms, which strained supplier relationships.

Financial leadership lacked reliable cashflow visibility — they could not answer questions about monthly vendor obligations or forecast quarterly outflows with confidence. Procurement was functionally disconnected from production data: when demand increased, procurement did not automatically adjust purchase orders, missing opportunities for volume discounts and creating supply chain vulnerability.

I quantified the impact: manual processing that consumed valuable finance hours, missed early payment discounts worth approximately $XX,XXX annually, and vendor on-time payment at roughly 65%. The objective was to build an integrated and auditable system that could shorten invoice cycle time, improve vendor payment reliability, capture early-payment discounts, and provide management with clear financial visibility.

Key Challenges Identified

- Manual invoice processing creating 5-7 day delays
- Duplicate invoices and inconsistent approval routing
- Unpredictable vendor payment timing (30-60 days)
- Lack of cashflow visibility for financial planning
- Procurement disconnected from production demand
- Missed early-payment discount opportunities

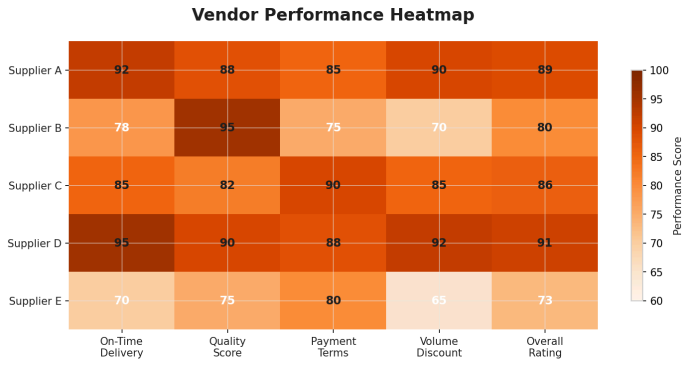

Figure 2: Vendor Performance Analysis Heatmap

SECTION 03

Our Approach

Process, Analysis & Design

I approached the project with a structured diagnostic mindset. The first step was conducting a gap analysis comparing the existing procurement capabilities with a target operating model. I performed timed walkthroughs of the current process, created BPMN diagrams for invoice and purchase order workflows, and developed a capability matrix to identify governance, process, and data gaps.

I also conducted a lightweight market analysis and competitor benchmarking to understand best practices in supplier management platforms and procurement automation systems. Additionally, I facilitated a SWOT analysis workshop with finance, procurement, and production stakeholders to identify strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and potential operational risks.

Using insights from these analyses, I developed a detailed business case and prioritized system capabilities that would deliver immediate operational value. I then translated these requirements into structured user stories and acceptance criteria. The system architecture I proposed included electronic invoice submission, automated PO matching, approval workflows, duplicate invoice detection, real-time procurement analytics dashboards, and automated payment execution through bank transfer integration.

1. Gap Analysis
2. Market Research
3. SWOT Workshop
4. Business Case
5. Architecture Design

Key Deliverables

- BPMN process diagrams for current and future state workflows
- Capability matrix identifying governance, process, and data gaps
- SWOT analysis with finance, procurement, and production stakeholders
- Business case with prioritized system capabilities
- Structured user stories with clear acceptance criteria
- System architecture proposal with integration specifications

SECTION 03

Our Approach

Implementation, UAT & Change Management

During implementation I served as the bridge between the outsourced development team and the internal finance and procurement stakeholders. I refined and managed user stories in JIRA, validated database schemas and integration logic, and ensured the system supported both operational transactions and reporting requirements.

I designed detailed UAT scenarios covering edge cases such as partial deliveries, PO mismatches, early-payment discount windows, and vendor escalation cases. Finance team members and vendor representatives were involved in executing these tests to validate real-world workflows. I facilitated daily defect triage meetings to prioritize fixes based on financial impact and vendor relationship risks.

In parallel, I led vendor onboarding activities, prepared user training guides, and conducted knowledge transfer sessions for the accounts payable team. A phased rollout strategy was implemented with pilot vendors to reduce operational risk. After go-live, a 72-hour hypercare support window ensured rapid issue resolution and allowed us to capture feedback for iterative improvements.

1. JIRA Story Management
2. UAT Scenario Design
3. Defect Triage
4. Vendor Onboarding
5. Phased Rollout

Implementation Highlights

- Bridged outsourced development team with internal stakeholders
- Designed comprehensive UAT scenarios covering edge cases
- Daily defect triage meetings prioritized by financial impact
- Led vendor onboarding and user training initiatives
- 72-hour hypercare support window post go-live
- Phased rollout strategy with pilot vendors

SECTION 04

The Value & Outcome I Delivered

The implementation of the Vendor Payment & Procurement System generated measurable operational and financial improvements. Invoice processing time decreased by 78%, significantly reducing manual reconciliation work and freeing finance resources for more strategic activities. Vendor on-time payment performance improved from 65% to 94%, strengthening supplier relationships and increasing vendor confidence.

The system also enabled the organization to capture early-payment discounts that had previously been missed due to processing delays. Integration of procurement with production demand allowed the organization to negotiate better pricing and achieve an average 12% volume discount with key suppliers. Real-time cashflow dashboards gave leadership clear visibility into payables obligations and short-term financial planning.

Beyond direct financial benefits, the system established strong audit trails, simplified vendor dispute resolution, and improved forecasting accuracy. Ultimately, the VPPS platform transformed procurement from a reactive administrative function into a transparent, data-driven capability that supports scalable business growth.

78% Reduction in Processing Time

65% → 94% On-Time Payment Improvement

12% Average Volume Discount Achieved

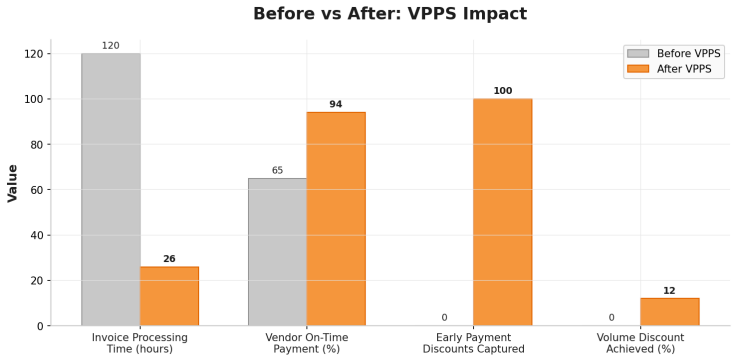

Figure 3: Before vs After VPPS Implementation Impact

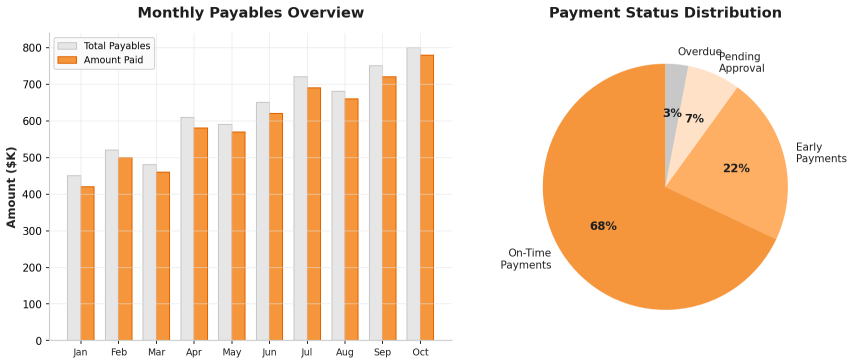

Figure 4: Real-Time Cashflow Visibility Dashboard